Who is buying gold?

Public correction notice. This edition preserves the 35-page V2 research report, original diagrams, original page labels and linked source register. This notice makes the complete file 36 pages. It is not the unchanged original PDF.

Removed: the unverified OCBC tracker passage on investment-manager futures exposure, options protection pricing and a roughly 0.9% Shanghai physical premium. Related OCBC evidence pointers and unsupported reading-guide assertions were removed or qualified. No replacement market figures were invented.

Research date: 6 November 2026. All market prices, holdings and forecasts retain their original observation dates and horizons. Some dated forecasts could not be independently rechecked in the earlier public-edition review; they remain attributed historical research claims, not current quotes or guaranteed outcomes.

Publication review checked text, hyperlinks, metadata, embedded content and graphics for client identities and restricted screenshots. The report contains original text/vector exhibits and links, not republished source-paper pages. Embedded content credentials were removed from this derivative to avoid carrying the original provenance as if it authenticated the edits.

This is a publication-safety correction, not a complete fresh verification of every market assertion. The original source file is preserved separately.

MARKET INTELLIGENCE HUB

EDITION 2 / PRECIOUS METALS

Who is buying gold?

Central-bank buyers, sellers and what drives a Singapore investor's return

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

321.2 t
Estimated Q3 official net buying

120 t
Publicly reported Q3 net buying

US$4,047.19
Spot per troy ounce · 6 Nov, 15:18 SGT

KEY FINDINGS

1. China and Poland led disclosed Q3 buying. Roughly 63% of total estimated demand cannot be attributed to named buyers.
2. A central bank may sell gold to raise currency, rebalance a portfolio or meet a policy obligation. The reason changes how to read the sale.
3. For Singapore investors, both the gold price and USD/SGD determine the unhedged return. Bank forecasts also have different dates and horizons.

Research checked to 6 November 2026, 16:40 SGT. Each exhibit identifies its own observation date.

THREE DIFFERENT CLOCKS

30 SEP
Official net buying
Q3 flows and period-end reserve volumes.

31 OCT
Gold fund flows
Month-end holdings and subscriptions.

6 NOV
Spot observation
Intraday US dollars per troy ounce.

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CHAPTER 01 / OFFICIAL DEMAND

Central banks bought more gold as the price weakened

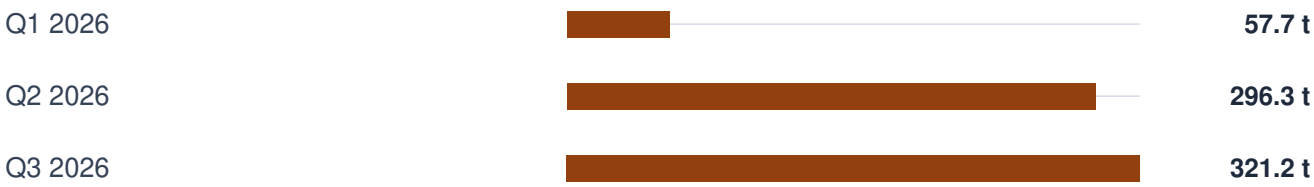
REPORTED FACTS

Official buyers stepped up sharply after a weak first quarter. The November data show a net 57.7 tonnes in Q1, 296.3 in Q2 and 321.2 in Q3. The last figure was 42% above a year earlier. Yet the World Bank reports that gold prices fell 5% from Q2 to Q3.

EXHIBIT 01.1 REPORTED AND ESTIMATED DATA

Official net purchases accelerated through 2026

Net metric tonnes by quarter · 3 November data release



Each bar starts at zero. Purchases less sales across central banks and other official institutions include estimated activity.

G1 World Gold Council / Metals Focus (3 Nov 2026) · G2 World Gold Council / Metals Focus (3 Nov 2026)

DATA REVISION

The estimate changed enough to alter the story of the year. The first Q1 release put buying at 244 tonnes. The Q2 release revised that sharply downward, and the November table puts it at 57.7. Combining April's Q1 estimate with November's Q2 and Q3 figures would exaggerate the level of demand and hide the rebound.

CHAPTER 01 / OFFICIAL DEMAND / CONTINUED

Central banks bought more gold as the price weakened

RESEARCH INTERPRETATION

Official demand is one influence on the market price. A reserve manager can add to a holding while other investors sell enough to push the price down.

EXHIBIT 01.2

REPORTED AND ESTIMATED DATA

Price and purchasing moved in opposite directions

Q3 versus Q2 2026 · changes as published

Measure	Quarter-on-quarter change
Official gold demand	+8%
Gold price, World Bank review	–5%

The observations describe the same quarter. They do not measure the price effect of an individual purchase.

G1 World Gold Council / Metals Focus (3 Nov 2026) · W1 World Bank (Oct 2026)

In plain English A large buyer can support demand while other investors sell enough to push the price down. Both sides of the market matter.

Sources G1 · G2 · G6 · G7 · W1

CHAPTER 02 / HOW TO READ THE DATA

Who bought the remaining gold?

SOURCE ESTIMATE

Public filings identify only part of Q3 buying. The World Gold Council puts disclosed net purchases at 120 tonnes, compared with roughly 321 tonnes after Metals Focus incorporates estimates. The gap covers late reporting and trades that never appear in time for publication. It cannot be reliably assigned to China, a Gulf state or another named buyer.

EXHIBIT 02.1 REPORTED AND ESTIMATED DATA

About 63% of Q3 net demand was unreported

Approximate decomposition · net metric tonnes · July–September 2026



Disclosed	**120 t**
Estimated remainder	**about 201 t**

The remainder uses source-rounded figures, 321 less 120. It has no reliable country-by-country breakdown.

G2 World Gold Council / Metals Focus (3 Nov 2026)

COVERAGE COMPARISON

The answer to “is buying up this year?” depends on the series. For January to September, reported purchases fell 7% year on year to 228 tonnes. Estimated demand rose 6% to 675 tonnes. Both comparisons can be right because their coverage differs. A monthly change in disclosed reserves is evidence about that balance sheet, while imports can also reflect households, jewellers, banks and funds.

EXHIBIT 02.2 REPORTED AND ESTIMATED DATA

The reporting perimeter changes the year-on-year conclusion

January–September 2026 · net metric tonnes

Coverage	2026	Year on year
Publicly reported	228 t	–7%
Reported plus estimated	675 t	+6%

The two rows overlap. Adding them would count publicly reported activity twice.

G2 World Gold Council / Metals Focus (3 Nov 2026) · G3 World Gold Council / IMF IFS / national authorities (4 Nov 2026)

In plain English The total estimate is larger than the list of named buyers. Keep that unknown portion visible when explaining who bought gold.

Sources G1 · G2 · G3

CHAPTER 03 / DISCLOSED BUYERS

China picked up the pace as Poland approached its target

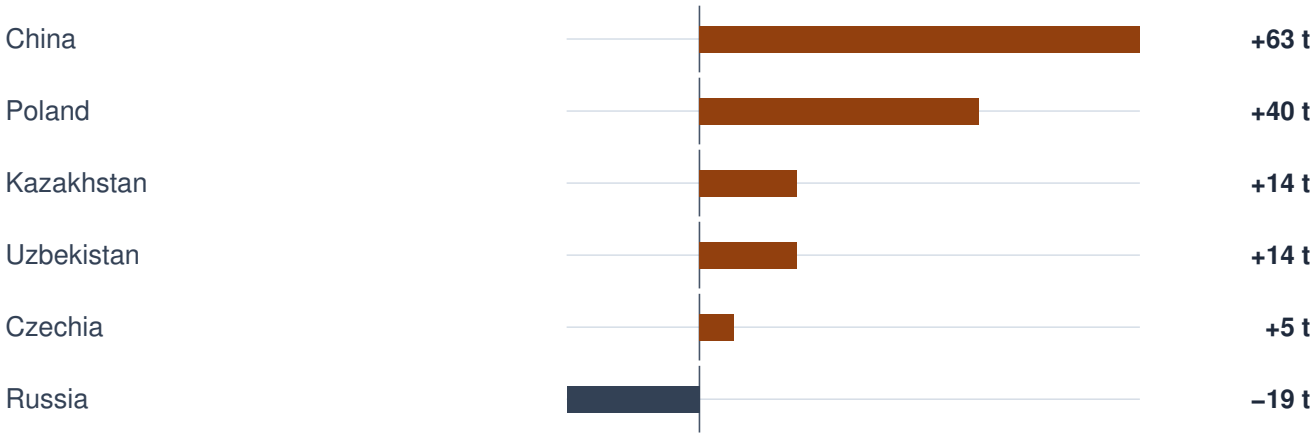
REPORTED FACT

China added 63 tonnes in Q3, more than half its purchases for the first nine months. Its September statement gives a direct check on the quantity. Holdings rose by 740,000 ounces to 77.47 million ounces, the 23rd consecutive monthly increase. The announcement gives no price target or motive for that month's purchase.

EXHIBIT 03.1 REPORTED DATA

Six disclosed changes show how concentrated buying was

Net tonnes, Q3 2026



Right of zero means a net addition. WGC's rounded figures put China and Poland together at 104 t on unrounded data, about 86% of reported net demand.

G2 World Gold Council / Metals Focus (3 Nov 2026)

REPORTED FACT

Poland's governor confirmed on 5 November that reserves had reached the 700-tonne goal. Quarterly additions slowed from 51 tonnes in Q2 to 40 tonnes in Q3. He left open further purchases as overall reserves grow.

CHAPTER 03 / DISCLOSED BUYERS / CONTINUED

China picked up the pace as Poland approached its target

SOURCE COMMENTARY

Uzbekistan illustrates how purchases can coexist with a willingness to sell. The central bank added 14 tonnes in Q3. Its governor had discussed selling at favourable prices as part of reserve management. A willingness to sell gives the bank flexibility and leaves the timing open.

EXHIBIT 03.2

REPORTED DATA

Two approaches to reserve accumulation

Policy evidence available by 5 November 2026

Institution	What is confirmed	What to watch
Poland	700-tonne target reached, governor said on 5 Nov.	A new allocation decision or evidence of continued purchases.
Czechia	87.4 tonnes held at end-Sep. CNB aims for 100 tonnes by 2028.	Progress toward a stated target and any change in the mandate.

A public target provides a reference point. Actual purchases and their timing still depend on the institution.

C4 Reuters (5 Nov 2026) · C5 Czech National Bank (Holdings observation end-September 2026. Page reviewed 6 November 2026)

In plain English China accelerated its buying, while Poland reached a stated goal. The next purchase depends on each institution’s policy.

Sources G2 · C3 · C4 · C15 · C5

CHAPTER 04 / DISCLOSED SELLERS

Gold supplied cash when some official holders needed it

ISSUER EXPLANATION

Russia's governor linked recent reductions mainly to the finance ministry's transactions under its fiscal rule. The National Wealth Fund holds assets that the ministry can use under that rule. The governor also cited metal used for coin production. The published explanation does not allocate the quarter's 19-tonne decline across those uses.

EXHIBIT 04.1 REPORTED DATA

Three different kinds of reduction

Metric tonnes and observation windows shown

Institution	Observed change	Evidence for the explanation
Bank of Russia	–19 t in Q3	Governor identified fiscal-rule operations and minting in September.
Türkiye	–81 t Jan–Sep · +1 t in Sep	March swaps provided FX liquidity. A monthly addition can coexist with a year-to-date reduction.
Azerbaijan · SOFAZ	200.0 t at Dec 2025 · 178.1 t in Mar and Sep 2026	Sovereign fund. Changes are calculated from its own period-end stocks.
Qatar, Kyrgyz Republic, UAE	Small Q3 reductions	WGC identified the declines. Individual motives were undisclosed.

Observation windows differ. SOFAZ reports quarterly and is excluded from WGC monthly totals. A period-end stock cannot reveal every intervening transaction.

G2 World Gold Council / Metals Focus (3 Nov 2026) · G3 World Gold Council / IMF IFS / national authorities (4 Nov 2026) · C8 Bank of Russia (11 Sep 2026) · C9 World Gold Council (29 Apr 2026) · C11 State Oil Fund of the Republic of Azerbaijan (Holdings observation 31 December 2025. Year-end 2025 results) · C12 State Oil Fund of the Republic of Azerbaijan (Holdings observation 31 March 2026. Q1 2026 results) · C10 State Oil Fund of the Republic of Azerbaijan (Holdings observation 30 September 2026. Page reviewed 6 November 2026)

ISSUER EXPLANATION

Türkiye used gold to obtain foreign currency when demand for cash rose. In March, the central bank both disposed of metal and arranged gold-for-currency swaps. Under a swap, the bank agrees to reverse the exchange at maturity. Adding the swap amount to outright sales would overstate the gold permanently sold.

REPORTED BALANCES

Azerbaijan's sovereign wealth fund reported the same gold stock in March and September. Its year-end to September holdings fell by 21.9 tonnes. The fund states its diversification policy and allocation limits. Its holdings disclosures leave the specific reason for the reduction open.

> **In plain English** Selling a reserve asset can mean using it for its intended purpose. First identify the transaction and the reason behind it.

CHAPTER 05 / READING THE GLOBAL REGISTER

The largest vaults tell a different story from the largest buyers

COVERAGE NOTE

A ranking by tonnes held identifies disclosed ownership at each holder's reporting date. The World Gold Council's register covers the top 100 disclosed holders and provides a separate file of changes. Most November entries refer to September, while some refer to June or earlier. The prior Hub report screened that roster. This update verifies selected moves and the cases below against their own disclosures.

EXHIBIT 05.1 REPORTED DATA

Ownership, custody, exposure and a reported zero

Reference dates and instrument types shown

Case	What the source measures	How to read it
United States	Treasury owns US official gold. The New York Fed holds metal for multiple owners.	A change in foreign client custody does not establish a US purchase.
Canada	Finance Canada showed US$0m for gold on 30 Oct 2026.	The source reports a zero position at its published precision.
South Korea	679,765 SPDR Gold Trust shares at end-Jun. Separately, 104.4 t of physical reserves.	Count ETF shares as securities. A planned December domestic buying channel was still prospective.

The WGC top-100 register is linked in the sources. A missing or stale observation leaves current activity unresolved.

C16 World Gold Council / IMF IFS / national authorities (4 Nov 2026 update) · C17 Federal Reserve (5 Nov 2024 update) · C18 Department of Finance Canada (4 Nov 2026) · C20 Reuters (13 Aug 2026) · C21 Reuters (1 Oct 2026)

OWNERSHIP AND REPORTING

Five legacy holders still account for about 52% of world gold reserves. Federal Reserve staff identify the United States, Germany, Italy, France and the IMF. Together they have added little since the 1970s. Their existing stock can rise by billions of dollars in value without producing a new purchase.

REPORTED HOLDINGS

Gold can arrive in a country's vault without the country buying it. The New York Fed stores metal for official account holders. South Korea also owns units in a gold fund. These give the central bank exposure to the price, while it reports a separate monetary-gold stock.

> **In plain English** A gold bar in a vault, a gold fund share and a customer's gold held in custody are different exposures. Compare like with like.

Sources C16 · C17 · C18 · F1 · C20 · C21 · H1

CHAPTER 06 / HISTORICAL REVERSALS

Czechia rebuilt its stock while Switzerland held steady

ISSUER HISTORY

Czechia reversed an earlier decision to sell most of its gold. The Czech National Bank resumed more active buying in 2023. Its own analysis found that a holding near 100 tonnes would make its financial results less sensitive to market swings. That explains the target from the perspective of this particular institution.

EXHIBIT 06.1 REPORTED DATA

Read the verb before reading the tonnes

Historical reported stocks and stated goals

Case	Starting position	Later position	Meaning
Czechia	8 t at end-2019 · about 12 t at end-2022	87.4 t in Sep 2026 · target 100 t by 2028	A deliberate rebuild
Switzerland	1,040 t at end-2008	1,040 t in the SNB's current disclosure	Long-running hold
European agreement	Official sales coordinated from 1999	Agreement expired in Sep 2019	End of a sales framework

The Czech target is a future policy objective. The other stock figures refer to holdings that the institutions reported.

C5 Czech National Bank (Holdings observation end-September 2026. Page reviewed 6 November 2026) · C6 Swiss National Bank (Reviewed 6 Nov 2026) · C7 European Central Bank (26 Jul 2019)

REPORTED HOLDINGS

The Swiss National Bank still holds the same 1,040 tonnes it held at the end of 2008. Its gold is stored in Switzerland, London and Canada to preserve access in a crisis. All three locations belong to the same Swiss stock. Counting the location of bars as a purchase would create a trade that never took place.

POLICY HISTORY

Europe's coordinated sales wound down before the agreement expired in 2019. The ECB said signatories had sold little for nearly a decade. A world in which legacy holders sell less and other reserve managers buy more can show net purchases even when few institutions reverse their own policy.

> **In plain English** Stopping sales leaves the quantity steady. Building a new position increases it. Those actions have different effects on demand.

CHAPTER 07 / CASE STUDY · GHANA

A gold export programme can earn dollars and lose money

REPORTED PROGRAMME DATA

Ghana turned locally mined gold into foreign currency during a debt crisis. When access to external borrowing tightened, the Bank of Ghana could buy gold from local producers in cedis and export it for dollars. In 2025 it purchased and exported about 104 tonnes of artisanal and small-scale gold worth US$10.9 billion. Most of that metal passed through the programme.

EXHIBIT 07.1 PROGRAMME MECHANISM

Follow the gold and the cash

Ghana · 2025 mechanism and July 2026 transition

1. **Local miners** Supply partially refined gold. Purchases require cedis and quality checks.
2. **Export channel** Assaying, services and sale to buyers produce costs and foreign-currency proceeds.
3. **Bank balance sheet** Dollars can replenish reserves or finance FX sales. The exchange-rate spread affects the accounts.

The US$10.9bn measures gross artisanal exports. The US$1.7bn figure measures programme losses and uses a different accounting basis.

C13 IMF (7 Aug 2026) · I1 IMF (9 Jul 2026)

IMF ANALYSIS

The same programme generated losses of over US$1.7 billion in 2025, equivalent to 1.5% of GDP. The IMF identifies the biggest contributor as the gap between the exchange rate used to buy the gold and the reference rate used in the bank's accounts. Assay fees, service charges and discounts to buyers added to losses. The estimate combines valuation effects and operating costs. It excludes the cost of sterilisation, the central bank's operations to absorb the local currency created through reserve purchases.

POLICY CHANGE

GoldBod took over the programme's operations and costs in July 2026. The central bank retained a role as fiscal agent and as recipient of monetary gold for reserves. A change in who buys raw metal can therefore occur alongside continued changes in central-bank bullion holdings.

> **In plain English** The programme exchanged locally bought gold for dollars. Costs and exchange-rate accounting could consume part of that benefit.

Sources C13 · I1

CHAPTER 08 / RESERVE MANAGEMENT

Why hold gold in reserves?

IMF ANALYSIS

A gold bar has no issuing government that must repay it. For a reserve manager, that feature can matter when access to foreign assets becomes uncertain. A bar held at home reduces exposure to a foreign custodian. It may still have to be moved, sold or pledged before the central bank can supply dollars to local banks. The IMF authors distinguish long-term reserves from the cash needed at short notice.

EXHIBIT 08.1 SOURCE ANALYSIS

Two uses of reserves lead to different choices

Reserve-management framework · IMF staff analysis, July 2026

Need	What the reserve manager considers
Pay USD obligations soon	Cash and readily saleable foreign assets can meet a known currency need.
Diversify a long-term portfolio	Physical gold removes issuer credit exposure but adds price volatility, custody costs and forgone interest.
Retain control under sanctions	Domestic custody can improve control. Converting those bars into usable FX can become harder under stress.

The same asset can protect against one risk and make a different risk harder to manage.

I1 IMF (9 Jul 2026)

IMF MODEL ILLUSTRATION

A reserve manager can allow for the risk of selling under stress. For bullion that can be liquidated within two days, IMF staff illustrate a 6–12% haircut using a 99% value-at-risk calculation with stressed volatility over 1998–2025. A haircut reduces the headline value counted as usable liquidity. The statistical model estimates a loss threshold under stated assumptions.

CHAPTER 08 / RESERVE MANAGEMENT / CONTINUED

Why hold gold in reserves?

SURVEY FINDINGS

More respondents expected global gold holdings to grow than expected their own bank to buy. Among respondents to the 2026 World Gold Council survey, 89% expected global official holdings to rise in the next year and 45% expected their own holdings to rise. Diversification, performance in crises and inflation protection featured in their answers. The survey records intentions. It cannot give the date or size of a trade.

EXHIBIT 08.2 SURVEY RESULTS

Expectations differ when managers speak about their own bank

Share of respondents to each question · survey published 16 June 2026



The answers concern the following 12 months. The questions have different subjects and do not add to 100%.

G5 World Gold Council (16 Jun 2026)

In plain English Gold can reduce dependence on an issuing government. Ready-to-use currency can be easier to deploy when bills come due.

Sources I1 · G5

CHAPTER 09 / GOLD AND US TREASURIES

A higher reserve share can come from the same bars

IMF ANALYSIS

Gold's share of reserves can rise before a central bank buys another ounce. The IMF authors found that between 2018 and 2025 the market value of official gold rose 268%, while the physical quantity rose about 8.5%. A reserve portfolio is like a household balance sheet. If a home appreciates, property becomes a larger share of wealth even when the family buys no property.

EXHIBIT 09.1 SOURCE ANALYSIS

Repricing the same end-2025 holdings changes their ranking

Share of total official reserves including gold · ECB estimates

Asset	At end-2025 prices	At end-2023 gold price
Gold	27%	16%
US Treasuries	22%	26%
Euro-denominated reserves	15%	16%

Read across each row. The ECB changed the price assigned to gold. Changing the total also changes the percentage share of the other assets. US Treasuries are a subset of dollar reserve assets. Dollar deposits and other dollar claims sit outside that column. Selected assets only.

E1 European Central Bank (Jun 2026)

FEDERAL RESERVE STAFF ANALYSIS

The ranking also changes when the investor group changes. A September Federal Reserve staff note points out that world gold includes US government gold, while foreign official Treasury holdings exclude the US. At end-2025, gold outside the US was worth US$4 trillion against US$3.9 trillion in foreign official Treasuries. By June 2026 Treasuries were ahead on that comparison even though gold ounces had increased.

> **In plain English** A family's home can become a larger share of its wealth without another property purchase. Gold's reserve share works similarly.

Sources I1 · E1 · F1

CHAPTER 10 / THE PRICE OF GOLD

Funds bought gold in October and still lost value

REPORTED FUND DATA

Investors added US$2.7 billion to gold funds in October, yet the funds finished the month worth less. The World Gold Council's specialised ETF report shows that physical holdings rose by 19 tonnes to 4,275 tonnes, while total assets fell 6% to US$542 billion. The lower price of the metal already in the vault outweighed the value of new subscriptions.

EXHIBIT 10.1 REPORTED DATA

October's three readings count different things

October 2026 · specialised ETF and derivatives report, 5 November

Observation	Change	What moved
Physical ETF holdings	+19 t	Metal held for investors
ETF assets under management	–6%	Market value of all holdings
COMEX managed-money net longs	–53 t equivalent	Futures positioning of this trader group

ETF data are for October month-end. The WGC cites the CFTC positioning report as of 28 October 2026 for the futures comparison. Tonnes equivalent expresses futures exposure in a gold-weight unit. Each series measures its own market and investor group.

G4 World Gold Council (5 Nov 2026)

SOURCE LIMITATION
The supplied OCBC tracker's positioning, options-pricing and Shanghai-premium observations have been omitted because the exact underlying passage was not independently inspected. No replacement figures have been introduced.

REPORTED DEMAND DATA

Households responded differently again. The World Gold Council's Q3 table showed bar-and-coin demand fell 19% year on year and jewellery consumption fell 17%. A higher price can discourage a wedding purchase even while an official buyer pursues a multi-year policy. The amount one group buys gives no mechanical price target for the next trade.

> **In plain English** Buying more ounces does not ensure the whole holding rises in value. The price of all the ounces already owned also matters.

CHAPTER 11 / MARKET CONTEXT

The income gold gives up

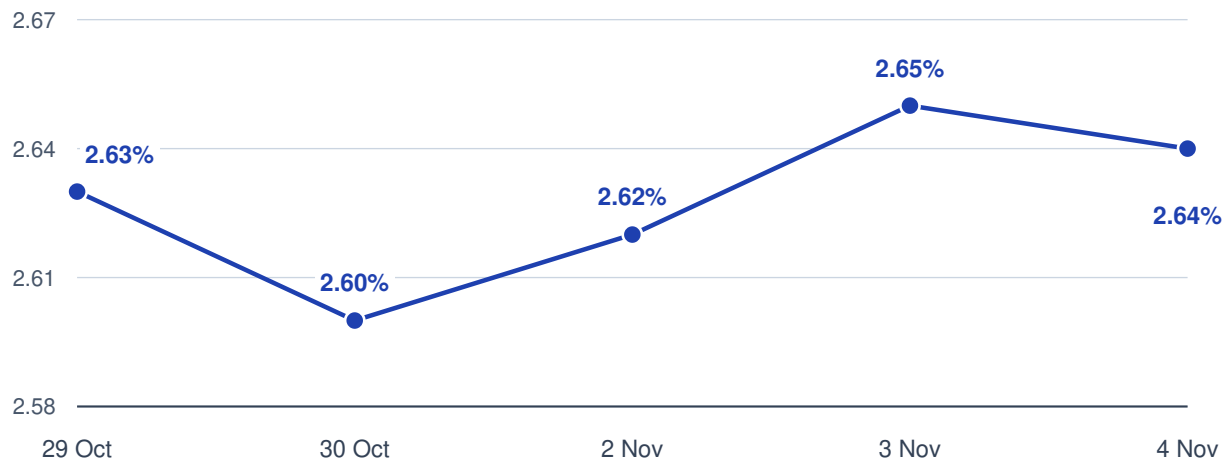
REPORTED FACTS

The U.S. 10-year real Treasury yield was 2.64% on 4 November. The five latest observations available at the research cutoff ranged from 2.60% to 2.65%. This series was updated on 5 November at 15:16 CST, equivalent to 6 November at 05:16 SGT. The observation date therefore precedes the report date.

EXHIBIT 11.1 OBSERVED DATA

Five published observations of the U.S. 10-year real yield

Percent per year • daily observations • narrowed vertical axis



Federal Reserve H.15 via FRED, DFII10. Latest observation 4 Nov 2026. Updated 5 Nov 2026, 15:16 CST. Each dot is a published business-day observation. The connecting segments aid reading between observed dates.

T1 Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, H.15 via FRED (Observation 4 November 2026. Updated 5 November 2026, 15:16 CST)

RESEARCH INTERPRETATION

A positive real yield creates an income hurdle for gold. Inflation-linked U.S. Treasury securities offer a quoted yield above inflation, while unlent physical gold pays no coupon. A higher real yield can make that income alternative more attractive. Central-bank purchases, investor flows, the U.S. dollar and liquidity can still move gold in the opposite direction over a short period.

> **In plain English** The yield is the income available above inflation from this Treasury alternative. Gold holders give up that income, so changes in the yield can affect how attractive gold feels.

Sources T1

CHAPTER 12 / BANK AND AGENCY OUTLOOKS

The World Bank and the Reuters poll disagree on 2027

FORECAST COMPARISON

Two October forecasts give opposite answers to the same question. For the average gold price in 2027, the World Bank estimates US$4,250 an ounce, US$350 below its 2026 figure. The Reuters poll puts 2027 at US$4,650, US$155 above its 2026 median. The gap between their 2027 forecasts is US$400. The two sources envisage different annual price paths.

EXHIBIT 12.1 DATED FORECASTS

Annual-average forecasts can be compared directly

Nominal US dollars per troy ounce · October 2026 publications

Forecast owner	2026 average	2027 average	Change
World Bank	4,600	4,250	–350
Reuters poll, median	4,495	4,650	+155

Read across a row for one forecast path. Read down the 2027 column to see the US$400 disagreement. These annual-average forecasts describe expected price levels.

W1 World Bank (Oct 2026) · R2 Reuters (27 Oct 2026)

RESEARCH INTERPRETATION

An annual average can fall even if gold ends the year above today's price. An average includes all the observations across the year. A high starting point or a few strong early months can lift it. Standard Chartered's targets instead describe where the bank expects gold to trade at particular horizons. Combining all these figures into a single target would answer no clear question.

> **In plain English** Compare annual averages with annual averages. A target for a particular date asks a different question.

Sources W1 · R2 · B1 · R1

CHAPTER 13 / DATED TARGETS

The target means more when its date is visible

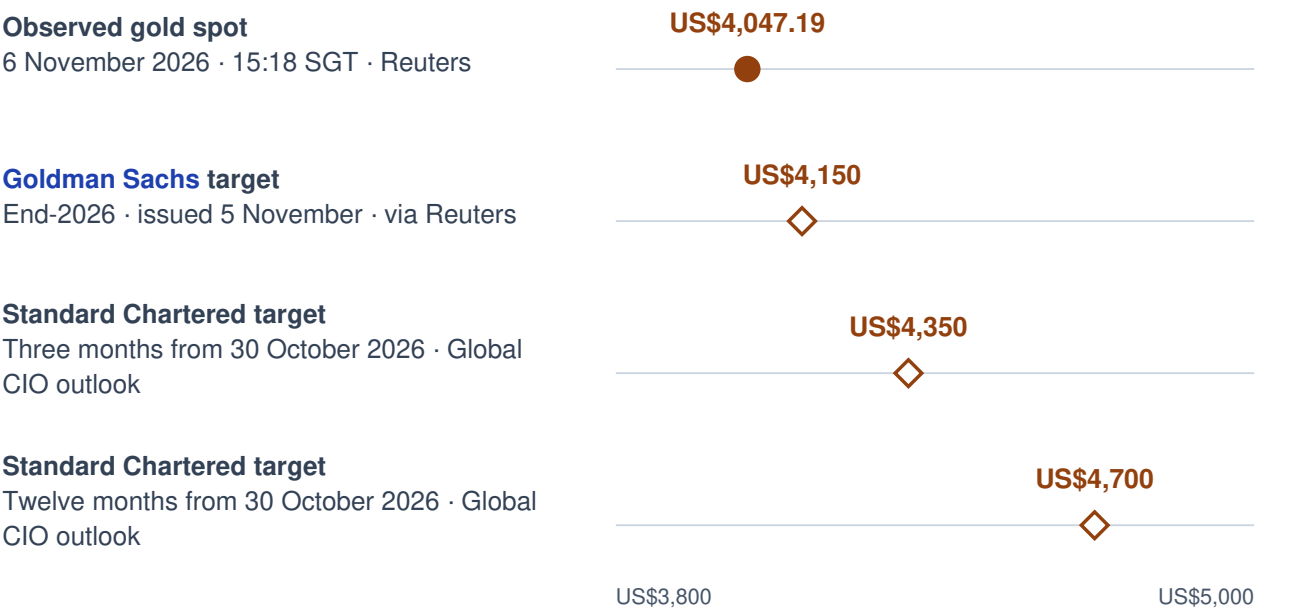
BANK FORECASTS

The quoted bank targets sit above the 6 November spot reference, across different horizons. Goldman Sachs lowered its end-2026 forecast to US$4,150, citing the Fed's more hawkish stance. Standard Chartered's 30 October report remained constructive over six to twelve months while trimming its nearer-term and longer-term targets.

EXHIBIT 13.1 OBSERVATION AND FORECASTS

One observed spot quote and three dated point targets

XAU/USD · US dollars per troy ounce · observed versus forecast levels



The filled circle is the observed spot quote. Open diamonds are bank targets. The horizontal axis shows price only. Bank issue dates and horizons appear beside each marker. The sources provide different views of rates, the dollar and demand.

R1 Reuters (6 Nov 2026) · B1 Standard Chartered (30 Oct 2026)

CHAPTER 13 / DATED TARGETS / CONTINUED

The target means more when its date is visible

RESEARCH INTERPRETATION

Each target is a level a particular forecast is trying to reach. The dots share a US-dollar price scale to make the levels readable. The banks issued them on different dates and for different horizons. A point target gives no forecast of the route between today and its target date.

EXHIBIT 13.2 SOURCE VIEWS

What each bank says matters

Stated rationale from the cited forecasts · 30 October and 5 November 2026

Forecast owner	Relevant assumptions or drivers
Goldman Sachs	A more hawkish Federal Reserve prompted a lower end-2026 target.
Standard Chartered	Near-term dollar strength and elevated real yields weigh against central-bank demand and longer-term diversification.

The descriptions summarise the banks' stated reasoning. Changes in those conditions can lead to further revisions.

R1 Reuters (6 Nov 2026) · B1 Standard Chartered (30 Oct 2026)

In plain English Read the date beside the target. A twelve-month view and a year-end view can differ without contradicting each other.

Sources R1 · B1

CHAPTER 14 / READING THE BANK PAPERS

What happened to J.P. Morgan’s US$6,000 call?

FORECAST REVISION

The US$6,000 forecast in the supplied paper was published on 9 June. The detailed table defined it as a Q4 2026 average. On 3 July Reuters reported a new J.P. Morgan forecast of US$4,500 for the same quarter. Comparing the same horizon gives a US$1,500 reduction, or 25%. The November date on the saved copy records when the web page was printed.

EXHIBIT 14.1 DATED FORECASTS

One bank, two forecasts for the same quarter

Q4 2026 average · US dollars per troy ounce · issue dates below



Each bar shows a dated bank forecast. The revision was (4,500 – 6,000) ÷ 6,000 = –25%.

J1 J.P. Morgan (9 Jun 2026) · J2 Reuters (3 Jul 2026)

BANK RESEARCH VIEW

The bank’s change of mind had a stated economic reason. By July it saw softer demand from key buyers and greater sensitivity to real yields. Real yield is the return a bond offers after allowing for inflation. When that return rises, investors give up more income by holding a bar that pays no coupon. Central banks can keep accumulating gold while private investors change what they are willing to pay for it.

> **In plain English** A downloaded paper can carry an old forecast. Check the original publication date and any subsequent revisions.

Sources J1 · J2

CHAPTER 15 / SINGAPORE RESERVES

MAS rebuilt some of the gold it had trimmed

REPORTED VOLUME

Singapore's reported gold rose by 323,268 fine troy ounces in the first nine months of 2026. That reverses the direction of the two preceding year-end changes. The September balance remained below December 2024.

EXHIBIT 15.1 REPORTED DATA

Gold on Singapore's official reserve return

Fine troy ounces · I.A(4), period end

Observation	Reported volume	Change from prior row
Dec 2023	7,395,505	—
Dec 2024	7,072,034	–323,471
Dec 2025	6,223,213	–848,821
Sep 2026, preliminary	6,546,481	+323,268

The last step covers nine months. These are changes between reported balances. They do not show individual trade dates or sale proceeds.

M4 Monetary Authority of Singapore (29 Feb 2024) · M3 Monetary Authority of Singapore (28 Feb 2025) · M2 Monetary Authority of Singapore (27 Feb 2026) · M1 Monetary Authority of Singapore (30 Oct 2026)

ACCOUNTING BASIS

MAS gives readers both an accounting value and a physical volume. Its September return shows US$6,223.50 million for gold on its published book-value basis and separately lists 6,546,481 fine troy ounces. Using the ounce line avoids turning accounting changes into assumed purchases. The category includes gold deposits and, where appropriate, swapped gold.

RESEARCH INTERPRETATION

The holdings series shows a partial rebuild. The direction of the disclosed volume change is observable. MAS's preferred entry price and its reason for each adjustment require separate evidence.

> **In plain English** The ounce line shows the change in reported gold volume. The accounting value alone cannot show how much MAS bought.

Sources M4 · M3 · M2 · M1

CHAPTER 16 / GOLD IN SINGAPORE DOLLARS

Follow the price in the currency you spend

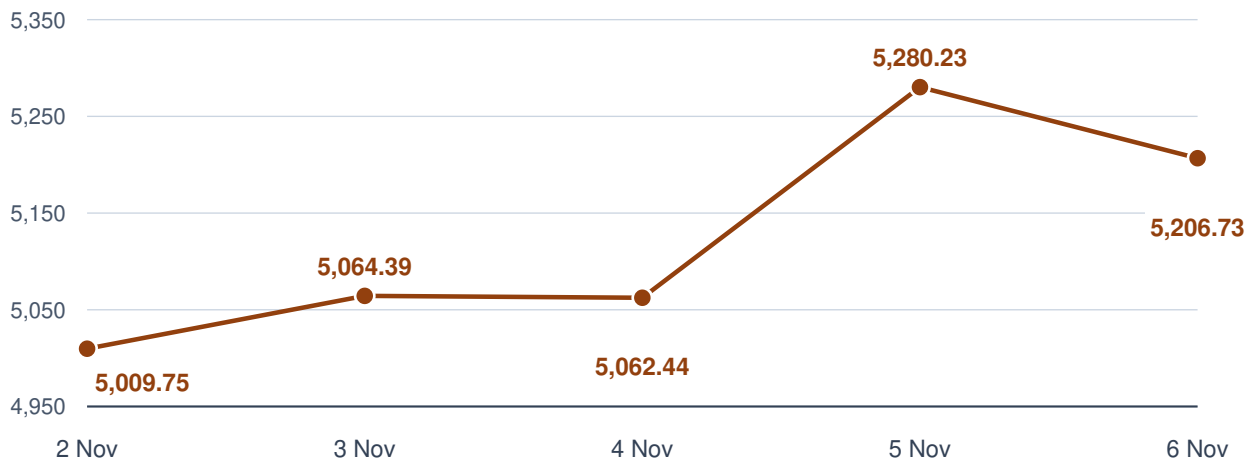
OBSERVED PRICES

Gold's local reference price rose from S$5,009.75 to S$5,206.73 per ounce between 2 and 6 November. The five daily 10am observations show a sharp rise on Thursday and a partial pullback on Friday. They give a local-currency view alongside the dated USD spot quote used for the bank-target comparison.

EXHIBIT 16.1 OBSERVED PRICES

The local gold reference rose, then pulled back

GoldSilver Central 10am reference · SGD per troy ounce · 2–6 November 2026



Points are same-time daily dealer references. The vertical scale starts at S$4,950 to show the week's movement. A gold price has no dividend adjustment. Dealing premiums, spreads and storage charges affect an investor's cash return.

P1 GoldSilver Central (6 Nov 2026, 10:00 SGT)

CHAPTER 16 / GOLD IN SINGAPORE DOLLARS / CONTINUED

Follow the price in the currency you spend

RESEARCH INTERPRETATION

Changing the observation time can change the comparison. Gold trades throughout the day. Compare the local 10am reference with other 10am observations before describing a daily move. The latest Reuters spot quote has a different timestamp and provider.

EXHIBIT 16.2 OBSERVED PRICES

The same dealer’s USD and SGD reference quotes

Price per troy ounce · 10:00 SGT on each day in November 2026

Date	USD / oz	SGD / oz
2 Nov	3,911.89	5,009.75
3 Nov	3,951.11	5,064.39
4 Nov	3,951.16	5,062.44
5 Nov	4,128.98	5,280.23
6 Nov	4,065.53	5,206.73

Use one provider and consistent observation times when comparing dates. These are reference quotations before investor-specific costs.

P1 GoldSilver Central (6 Nov 2026, 10:00 SGT)

In plain English A Singapore-dollar gold quote already incorporates the currency conversion. Match the source and time before comparing two days.

Sources P1 · R1

CHAPTER 17 / THE CURRENCY TRANSLATION

A stronger SGD can reduce the local gold return

RESEARCH INTERPRETATION

USD/SGD measures the Singapore dollars needed to buy one U.S. dollar. A lower reading means the U.S. dollar buys fewer Singapore dollars. With the USD gold price held constant, that change reduces the SGD value of an unhedged gold holding.

EXHIBIT 17.1 HISTORICAL FX OBSERVATIONS

Read the direction before reading the gold return

USD/SGD • SGD per USD • daily New York noon buying rates

Observation date	SGD per USD
2026-10-26	1.2809
2026-10-27	1.2804
2026-10-28	1.2827
2026-10-29	1.2801
2026-10-30	1.2776

Federal Reserve H.10 via FRED, DEXSIUS. Observations 26–30 October 2026. Published 2 November, 15:51 CST, or 3 November, 05:51 SGT. Lower USD/SGD means a stronger SGD against USD. Use matching entry and exit timestamps when calculating a realised return.

T2 Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, H.10 via FRED (Observation 30 October 2026. Updated 2 November 2026, 15:51 CST)

HISTORICAL FX REFERENCE

The latest published observation in this series was 1.2776 on 30 October. These five observations were released on 2 November, before the report cutoff. They illustrate the quote direction and the conversion mechanism. The dated dealer gold series supplies the more recent local-currency price context.

> **In plain English** Gold and currency both affect your SGD result. If the U.S. dollar weakens, each dollar of gold value converts into fewer Singapore dollars.

Sources T2

CHAPTER 18 / THE SINGAPORE INVESTOR

Translate the gold return into the currency you spend

CURRENCY MATHEMATICS

A Singapore investor who owns unhedged gold has two prices to watch. XAU/USD quotes the US dollars needed to buy one troy ounce. USD/SGD quotes the Singapore dollars needed to buy one US dollar. Multiply the two at the same time to get Singapore dollars per ounce. A stronger Singapore dollar means each US dollar of gold proceeds converts into fewer Singapore dollars.

EXHIBIT 18.1 MATHEMATICAL EXPLANATION

From two market quotes to a Singapore-dollar return

Unhedged exposure · same quantity · before dealing costs

1. **Entry value per ounce** Entry XAU/USD × entry USD/SGD.
2. **Exit value per ounce** Exit XAU/USD × exit USD/SGD.
3. **Gross SGD return** (Exit SGD value ÷ entry SGD value – 1) × 100%.

For an actual cash return, compare SGD paid including fees with SGD received net of sale costs. A currency-hedged share class follows a different calculation.

H1 Market Intelligence Hub (5 Nov 2026)

CHAPTER 18 / THE SINGAPORE INVESTOR / CONTINUED

Translate the gold return into the currency you spend

INSTRUMENT COMPARISON

Use the actual instrument and matching timestamps at both ends. A physical bar has a dealer spread and may carry storage costs. An ETF has a fee and its trading price can differ from the value of its gold. A derivatives contract can add collateral, leverage or rolling costs. The earlier Hub study traced XAU39344-USD to a derivatives listing. Joining that series to a spot quote would give a misleading return.

EXHIBIT 18.2 MATHEMATICAL EXPLANATION

How the currency leg changes the outcome

Unhedged holding · direction only

Gold in USD	USD/SGD	What it means in SGD
Rises	Rises	Both price moves help.
Rises	Falls	FX can reduce, erase or reverse the gold gain.
Flat	Falls	SGD gold loses value before costs.

USD/SGD falls when the Singapore dollar strengthens against the US dollar. The HTML calculator accepts your own two dated gold and FX quotes.

H1 Market Intelligence Hub (5 Nov 2026)

In plain English To find your return in Singapore dollars, combine the change in gold's USD price with the change in USD/SGD.

Sources H1 · M1

CHAPTER 19 / PORTFOLIO DECISIONS

What would change the investment case?

RESEARCH FRAMEWORK

Choose the reason for holding gold before choosing an entry. If the objective is long-term diversification, ask whether the position still helps when it loses value at the same time as shares. If the objective is a short trade, the price of money, the US dollar and leveraged positioning can matter sooner than the next quarterly reserve release. A cash need in SGD requires a separate currency and liquidity decision.

EXHIBIT 19.1 CONDITIONAL ANALYSIS

Three possible paths and the evidence to watch

Conditional scenarios as at 6 November 2026 · no assigned probabilities

Scenario	What to look for	Decision to revisit
Support broadens	Real yields ease, the dollar softens and physical ETF holdings keep rising.	Check whether the price recovery also reaches the SGD investor.
Gold trades sideways	Official demand persists while private investors disagree and yields stay high.	Revisit the holding horizon and the income forgone on cash or bonds.
A cash squeeze	Futures longs shrink, ETF holdings roll over or a stronger dollar tightens liquidity.	Check funding needs, available cash and tolerance for an interim loss.

Read each row as a combination of signals. A single data point, including a central-bank release, cannot confirm an entry price.

G4 World Gold Council (5 Nov 2026) · I1 IMF (9 Jul 2026) · B1 Standard Chartered (30 Oct 2026)

CHAPTER 19 / PORTFOLIO DECISIONS / CONTINUED

What would change the investment case?

CONDITIONAL ANALYSIS

A useful test is to specify what would change your mind. A stronger dollar and rising real yields can pressure gold even as official demand holds up. Conversely, easier real yields and persistent investment inflows can support a recovery. These are conditional paths. Data observed together can support a narrative without proving which trade moved the price.

EXHIBIT 19.2 CONDITIONAL ANALYSIS

What to check next

Monitoring schedule · research framework

When	Series	What would matter
Daily	Gold spot, real yields, USD/SGD	Compare synchronised observations and the price of the instrument held.
Monthly	ETF holdings and national reserve volumes	Distinguish physical additions from valuation and currency effects.
Quarterly	WGC demand, estimate revisions, bank outlooks	Rebuild the series from one release and compare targets with the same horizon.

Keep the observation date beside every number. A target being reached, or a forecast being cut, is a reason to revisit its contribution.

G1 World Gold Council / Metals Focus (3 Nov 2026) · G3 World Gold Council / IMF IFS / national authorities (4 Nov 2026) · G4 World Gold Council (5 Nov 2026) · B1 Standard Chartered (30 Oct 2026)

> **In plain English** Decide what the holding is meant to do, then watch the evidence that would support or weaken that purpose.

Sources G1 · G3 · G4 · B1 · I1

CHAPTER 20 / READING GUIDE

Which research paper answers which question?

READING GUIDE

The most useful papers look at different parts of the gold market. The IMF authors study what a reserve manager can do with bullion in a crisis. The ECB and Federal Reserve papers test how much of the rise in gold's reported importance comes from prices and existing holdings. Bank outlooks focus more closely on the marginal buyer and the next few quarters.

EXHIBIT 20.1 READING GUIDE

A reading list by research question

Selected publisher papers · 2026

Read this for…	Primary paper	Where to start
How quickly bars can become usable cash	IMF · Gold in Central Bank Reserves	Liquidity and custody sections
How a domestic purchase scheme works	IMF · Lessons from Ghana	Figures 5–7 and printed pp. 5–8
Whether gold displaced Treasuries	ECB · International role of the euro / FEDS Notes	ECB chart 7 / Fed figures 1–3
A baseline for annual gold prices	World Bank · Commodity Markets Outlook	Table 1 and pp. 46–47
Near-term pricing pressure and target revisions	Standard Chartered / J.P. Morgan	SC p. 15 / JPM forecast table

Use issuer disclosures for country-specific motives, researcher analysis for mechanisms and dated forecasts for expectations. The source directory links each paper or its publisher.

I1 IMF (9 Jul 2026) · E1 European Central Bank (Jun 2026) · F1 Federal Reserve (3 Sep 2026) · W1 World Bank (Oct 2026) · B1 Standard Chartered (30 Oct 2026) · J1 J.P. Morgan (9 Jun 2026) · J3 J.P. Morgan (13 Aug 2026) · C13 IMF (7 Aug 2026)

SOURCE SCOPE

The silver paper helps define the limits of the gold argument. J.P. Morgan's silver research discusses solar manufacturers reducing silver use. That industrial channel is less central to official gold demand and does not identify undisclosed gold buyers.

> **In plain English** Use the country's own disclosure for its reported holdings, research papers for mechanisms and dated forecasts for expectations.

Sources I1 · E1 · F1 · W1 · B1 · J1 · J3

REFERENCE REGISTER

Sources and further reading

Select a publication title to open the source. Page and exhibit references identify the evidence used in the report.

G1 **Gold Demand Trends, Q3 2026**
World Gold Council, Metals Focus and contributors · 3 Nov 2026
Table 1. Revised quarterly quantities through 30 September.

G2 **Central banks and other official institutions**
World Gold Council and Metals Focus · 3 Nov 2026
Q3 disclosures captured to 30 October. See notes 1–4 for coverage.

G3 **Central Bank Gold Statistics, September 2026**
World Gold Council, IMF IFS and national authorities · 4 Nov 2026
September and year-to-date reported changes. Monthly totals exclude quarterly-only SOFAZ.

G4 **Gold ETF Flows, October 2026**
World Gold Council · 5 Nov 2026
Published 5 November. ETF data through 31 October 2026. Footnote 7 identifies the CFTC positioning report as of 28 October 2026. Futures changes are tonnes equivalent.

G5 **Central Bank Gold Reserves Survey 2026**
World Gold Council · 16 Jun 2026
Survey fielded 5 February–19 May. A total of 76 responses, with bases varying by question.

G6 **Gold Demand Trends, Q2 2026**
World Gold Council and Metals Focus · Jul 2026
Historical release. Explains the Q1 demand revision and movement in Türkiye.

G7 **Gold Demand Trends, Q1 2026**
World Gold Council · 29 Apr 2026
First Q1 release. Retained to document the original estimate.

I1 **Gold in Central Bank Reserves**
IMF Notes 2026/007, Istvan Mak and Etienne Vaccaro-Grange · 9 Jul 2026
Printed p. 6, Figure 2, and Box 2 on printed pp. 19–20. The haircut uses 99% value at risk, a two-day horizon and stressed volatility over 1998–2025. Authors' analysis.

REFERENCE REGISTER

Sources and further reading · continued

E1 **The international role of the euro**
European Central Bank · Jun 2026
Printed pp. 14–15, chart 7a and accompanying text. End-2025 reserve shares under two price bases.

F1 **Why Gold Didn't Actually Overtake Treasury Securities as the World's "Favorite" Reserve Asset**
Federal Reserve Board, FEDS Notes, Colin Weiss · 3 Sep 2026
Figures 1–3 and appendix. Author's findings on valuation, legacy reserves and investor coverage.

W1 **Commodity Markets Outlook, October 2026**
World Bank · Oct 2026
Printed p. 13, table 1, and pp. 46–47, precious metals. Annual nominal USD averages.

R1 **Gold drops over 1% on higher oil prices**
Reuters · 6 Nov 2026
07:18 GMT (15:18 SGT) spot observation. Also reports Goldman Sachs' 5 November year-end forecast cut.

R2 **Strong dollar, high yields drag on gold outlook**
Reuters commodities poll · 27 Oct 2026
Median annual-average forecasts from 30 analysts and traders.

J1 **Will gold prices hit all-time highs again in 2026?**
J.P. Morgan Global Research · 9 Jun 2026
Forecast table, Q4 averages. The supplied printout carries a November print date.

J2 **JPMorgan sees weaker near-term demand**
Reuters reporting on J.P. Morgan research · 3 Jul 2026
Same Q4 2026 forecast horizon as the June table. This is a documented July revision.

B1 **Global Market Outlook, November 2026**
Standard Chartered Global CIO Office · 30 Oct 2026
Printed p. 15. Gold view and three- and twelve-month point targets.

REFERENCE REGISTER

Sources and further reading · continued

O1 **Precious Metals Tracker · Searching for a Floor**
OCBC Global Markets, Christopher Wong · 26 Oct 2026
Unverified source; observations omitted. Portal for further reading only.

M1 **International Reserves and Foreign Currency Liquidity**
Monetary Authority of Singapore · 30 Oct 2026
September 2026 preliminary return as retrieved for this edition. Item I.A(4), fine troy ounces and book value.

M2 **International Reserves and Foreign Currency Liquidity, December 2025**
Monetary Authority of Singapore · 27 Feb 2026
Item I.A(4), gold in fine troy ounces.

M3 **International Reserves and Foreign Currency Liquidity, December 2024**
Monetary Authority of Singapore · 28 Feb 2025
Item I.A(4), gold in fine troy ounces.

M4 **International Reserves and Foreign Currency Liquidity, December 2023**
Monetary Authority of Singapore · 29 Feb 2024
Item I.A(4), gold in fine troy ounces.

H1 **Gold and central banks · original public edition**
Market Intelligence Hub · 5 Nov 2026
Original 34-page research and 100-holder screening methodology. Individual reporting dates vary.

J3 **Silver price forecast for 2026 and 2027**
J.P. Morgan Global Research · 13 Aug 2026
Silver-demand discussion and forecast table. Industrial applications include solar panels.

C3 **China’s official reserve holdings in September**
State Council Information Office, reporting SAFE data · 8 Oct 2026
End-September physical holdings and change from August.

C4 **Polish central bank reaches 700-tonne target**
Reuters, reporting Governor Adam Glapiński’s press conference · 5 Nov 2026
Governor’s 5 November remarks, after Q3 closed.

REFERENCE REGISTER

Sources and further reading · continued

C5 **The CNB’s gold**
Czech National Bank · Holdings observation end-September 2026. Page reviewed 6 November 2026
The history of the country’s gold reserves, the advantages of gold and restoration of reserves.

C6 **Questions and answers on the SNB’s balance sheet**
Swiss National Bank · Reviewed 6 Nov 2026
How large are the SNB’s gold holdings and where are they stored?

C7 **Central banks conclude Central Bank Gold Agreement**
European Central Bank · 26 Jul 2019
Reasons for allowing the 1999–2019 sales-coordination agreements to expire.

C8 **Governor’s statement and Q&A after the board meeting**
Bank of Russia · 11 Sep 2026
Answer to PRO.FINANSY on fiscal-rule transactions and coin production.

C9 **Gold Demand Trends Q1 2026 · Central banks**
World Gold Council, quoting CBRT Governor Fatih Karahan · 29 Apr 2026
Country section on Türkiye. Footnote 5 refers to the governor’s 31 March comments. Q1 aggregate superseded.

C10 **Gold sub-portfolio and investment policy**
State Oil Fund of the Republic of Azerbaijan · Holdings observation 30 September 2026. Page reviewed 6 November 2026
Period-end gold holding and portfolio limit.

C11 **Investment results · year-end 2025**
State Oil Fund of the Republic of Azerbaijan · Holdings observation 31 December 2025. Year-end 2025 results
PDF p. 4, portfolio composition.

C12 **Investment results · Q1 2026**
State Oil Fund of the Republic of Azerbaijan · Holdings observation 31 March 2026. Q1 2026 results
PDF p. 4, portfolio composition.

REFERENCE REGISTER

Sources and further reading · continued

C13 **Lessons from the Bank of Ghana's Domestic Gold Purchase Programme**
IMF Selected Issues Paper 2026/084 · Guillaume Nolin · 7 Aug 2026
Printed pp. 2, 5, 7–8, especially paragraphs 7, 11, 13–14. Attached PDF pp. 6, 9, 11–12.

C15 **Central-bank gold statistics for July**
World Gold Council · 3 Sep 2026
Uzbekistan paragraph reports Governor Timur Ishmetov's comments on potential sales.

C16 **Gold Reserves by Country · top-100 holder register**
World Gold Council / IMF IFS · 4 Nov 2026 update
Latest month-end for the 100 largest disclosed holders. Most observations are September 2026, with June or earlier for some late reporters. Download and dashboard access can require a login.

C17 **Does the Federal Reserve own or hold gold?**
Federal Reserve Board · 5 Nov 2024 update
Treasury ownership, Federal Reserve gold certificates, and New York Fed custody for account holders.

C18 **Official International Reserves · November release**
Department of Finance Canada · 4 Nov 2026
Position as of 30 October 2026, official reserves by asset class, US$ millions.

C20 **Bank of Korea's US-listed gold ETF holding**
Reuters, reporting a US SEC filing · 13 Aug 2026
End-June count of SPDR Gold Trust shares and bank official's comment.

C21 **Bank of Korea plans purchases from domestic producers**
Reuters, quoting Bank of Korea official · 1 Oct 2026
104.4 t at end-June. Planned December purchasing system. Volume and execution timing not fixed.

P1 **GSC 10AM reference gold prices**
GoldSilver Central · 6 Nov 2026, 10:00 SGT
Five daily reference observations, 2–6 November 2026. One troy ounce of gold in USD and SGD. Dealer reference series.

REFERENCE REGISTER

Sources and further reading · continued

T1

10-Year Treasury Inflation-Indexed Security, Constant Maturity [DFII10]

Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, H.15 via FRED · Observation 4 November 2026. Updated 5 November 2026, 15:16 CST

Latest five daily observations, 29 October–4 November 2026. Percent, not seasonally adjusted.

T2

Singapore Dollars to U.S. Dollar Spot Exchange Rate [DEXSIUS]

Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, H.10 via FRED · Observation 30 October 2026. Updated 2 November 2026, 15:51 CST

Daily noon buying rates in New York City. Singapore dollars per U.S. dollar. Latest five observations, 26–30 October 2026.